29. Protecting family, food and shelter in a crisis — security without violence (English)

Oracle OS guide (Swedish, Norwegian, Finnish civil-protection guides, FEMA, Ready Scotland). The best defence is **not being a target**, **united neighbours** and **knowing when to leave**. Traps aimed at people are a crime almost everywhere and maim innocents (children, rescuers, neighbours) — don't use them.

Low profile

Don't show or post about food, water, fuel or generators; minimise light and noise at night if looting is reported; **split supplies** across several hiding places (and with relatives elsewhere); keep a small "giveaway" stash.

Harden the home

Locked doors and windows, quality lock/bar on the main door, film or bars on ground-floor windows, battery/solar motion lights, a dog. A **safe room** with a solid door, phone/radio, water, torch, first aid. Fire extinguisher and clear exits — fire is often a bigger risk than intruders.

Community — the strongest protection

Know neighbours; organise **street watch** shifts, signals (whistle, PMR446 channel), meeting point; share water, cooking, care for the elderly and children, radio news. Volunteer with **civil protection, fire services, Red Cross** or official civil defence — that is how to defend your community and country lawfully.

If someone threatens your family

Your life is worth more than food. Against weapons or groups, hand over what they want, observe, move away. Stay calm, hands visible, give them an exit. Children to the safe room; call **112 / 999 / 911** or use the radio; report afterwards. Self-defence must be **necessary and proportionate** to an ongoing attack; in the UK carrying weapons (including knives and sprays) for self-defence is illegal. Know your country's law.

Know when to leave

If the area becomes lawless, waterless or a combat zone, a **planned evacuation** is the best defence: grab bag, agreed route, meeting point outside town, discreet note for relatives.

Food from the land, legally

See the **small-game trapping** and fishing chapters of the SurvivalManual (US Army FM 21-76) in the library and follow local hunting laws.